MADINAH ZIYARAT: 05

ASJID AL-SAJDAH (ABU DHARR)

LOCATION

Masjid al-Sajdah is located approximately 800 metres north of Al-Masjid an-Nabawi, near the intersection of Abu Dharr Street and Airport Street in Madinah. It is also known by the names Masjid al-Shukr, Masjid al-Buhayr, and Masjid al-Aswaf.

TIMINGS

The mosque is open for visits and prayer during the times of the obligatory prayers. No separate fixed visiting hours are officially stated in the available visitor information.

ABOUT THE SITE

Masjid al-Sajdah, commonly known today as Masjid Abu Dharr, is one of the historical mosques associated with the Seerah of Prophet Muhammad ﷺ. It is traditionally identified as the place where the Messenger of Allah ﷺ performed a long prostration after receiving glad tidings from Jibril عليه السلام.

The mosque is called “al-Sajdah” because of this prostration and “al-Shukr” because it is associated with gratitude to Allah. Its importance comes from the reported event connected with the Prophet ﷺ, not from claims of a separate ritual or guaranteed reward for visiting it.

MASJID AL-MUSTARAH

For pilgrims exploring Ziyarat in Madinah, the mosque offers an opportunity to learn about gratitude, prayer, and the careful preservation of places linked with Islamic history. Its story is remembered through historical works and modern heritage records, although the strength of the report describing the event should be understood honestly.

HISTORICAL BACKGROUND

The Report of the Prostration

The event associated with Masjid al-Sajdah was narrated by Abd al-Rahman ibn Awf رضي الله عنه. He reported seeing the Prophet ﷺ enter a palm garden and remain in prostration for so long that he feared the Messenger of Allah ﷺ had passed away. When the Prophet ﷺ raised his head, he explained that Jibril عليه السلام had brought glad tidings concerning blessings and greetings for those who sent blessings and peace upon him. The Prophet ﷺ then prostrated in gratitude to Allah.

- The report presents prostration as an expression of thankfulness to Allah.
- Abd al-Rahman ibn Awf رضي الله عنه was among the well-known Companions.
- The event is connected with sending blessings and peace upon the Prophet ﷺ.
- The mosque's popular names come from this reported incident.

MASJID AL-MUSTARAH

Names Connected With the Place

Historical sources record several names for the site. These names reflect its location, its surrounding landscape, or the event associated with it. “Masjid al-Sajdah” refers to the prostration, while “Masjid al-Shukr” refers to gratitude. The name “Masjid Abu Dharr” became widely used in later centuries, although the mosque is not being presented as a place where Abu Dharr رضي الله عنه necessarily lived or performed a uniquely established act of worship.

- “Al-Aswaf” was connected with the area surrounding the mosque.
- “Al-Buhayr” referred to the palm area mentioned in historical descriptions.
- “Al-Safilah” appears among the recorded names.
- “Masjid Abu Dharr” is its best-known present-day name.

Historical Evidence and Caution

The identification of the present mosque with the place of the Prophet’s prostration comes through historical and local tradition recorded by Madinah historians. The Madinah Heritage Encyclopedia cites early and later works, including accounts by al-Mutri and al-Samhudi. However, the narration used for the event has been judged weak by a hadith editor. Therefore, the story may be shared as a reported historical association, but it should not be stated as an unquestionable authentic hadith.

MASJID AL-MUSTARAH

- Al-Mutri referred to the mosque in the eighth Islamic century.
- Al-Samhudi recorded information about its location and names.
- Later historians continued discussing its identity.
- The report's weakness requires careful wording and humility.

The Mosque Through the Centuries

The physical building did not always resemble the mosque visitors see today. Historical descriptions portray an earlier, very small structure, and later writers recorded periods when it was damaged or partly ruined. Its continued identification reflects Madinah's long effort to preserve places connected with the Prophetic period, even when buildings changed or disappeared.

- Earlier descriptions mention a small and simple mosque.
- Some later visitors found it damaged or in poor condition.
- Its location was preserved through historical descriptions.
- The mosque was rebuilt and enlarged during the Saudi era.

SITE TODAY

A Preserved Historical Mosque

Today, Masjid al-Sajdah remains a functioning historical mosque in northern Madinah. Its present identity comes from the combination of its traditional

MASJID AL-MUSTARAH

names, its recorded association with the Prophet ﷺ, and its continued place within Madinah's heritage landscape.

Modern Architectural Form

The mosque has been rebuilt in a modern architectural form. Heritage records state that its area was expanded to approximately 182.3 square metres, with a minaret added at the northwestern corner. Visitors should remember that the current structure is a later building marking a historically identified location, not the unchanged original structure.

Reaching the Site

Its proximity to Al-Masjid an-Nabawi makes it accessible during a visit to central Madinah. Visitors should confirm the route locally, allow time for traffic and walking, and follow current directions because streets and access arrangements can change.

Conduct During a Visit

The mosque should be approached as a place of worship and heritage, not as a site for invented rituals. Visitors may pray when permitted, learn its history, and maintain quiet, cleanliness, and respect. No special prayer, guaranteed reward, or independent religious virtue should be attributed to the mosque without reliable evidence.

WHY IT STILL MATTERS

MASJID AL-MUSTARAH

Masjid al-Sajdah matters because its remembered history places gratitude at the centre of a human moment. The report does not describe worldly power or victory; it describes a servant of Allah ﷻ responding to good news through prostration. That detail gives the site a quiet lesson: blessings are not only received with words, but also acknowledged through humility before Allah. At the same time, differing assessments of the report teach visitors to respect both devotion and historical responsibility. A meaningful Ziyarat in Madinah allows the heart to remember the Seerah while the mind remains careful about what can truly be claimed.

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

Where is Masjid al-Sajdah located?

It is approximately 800 metres north of Al-Masjid an-Nabawi, near Abu Dharr Street and Airport Street in Madinah.

Why is it called Masjid al-Sajdah?

It is traditionally associated with a long prostration of the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ after receiving glad tidings from Jibril عليه السلام. It is also called Masjid al-Shukr because the prostration is described as one of gratitude.

Can visitors pray at Masjid al-Sajdah?

MASJID AL-MUSTARAH

The mosque is open for visits and prayer during the obligatory prayer times, according to available visitor information. Visitors should follow local instructions and current access arrangements.

MASJID AL-MUSTARAH